How to install the Humanitarian Icons

Version 3.0, for ArcGIS Pro and QGIS.

What you need

- The font: Humanitarian-Icons.ttf
- For ArcGIS Pro: humanitarian-icons-arcgis-pro.stylx
- For QGIS: humanitarian-icons-v3-qgis-ttf.xml

Download the files from the humanitarian-icons-v3 branch of the ocha-humanitarian-icons-for-gis repository on GitHub, or take the single zip file humanitarian-icons-v3.zip from the downloads folder and unzip it.

How it works

Each icon is a character in the font, and the style file holds one ready-made symbol per icon: 15 pt, black, with a white halo that is 0.5 pt wide and half transparent. The font must be installed before the symbols will draw. If you see empty boxes instead of icons, the font is missing or the program was not restarted.

Step 1: install the font (do this first)

Windows

1. Unzip the download and find Humanitarian-Icons.ttf.
2. Right-click the file and choose Install for all users (or double-click it and choose Install).
3. Close ArcGIS Pro and QGIS if they are open, then open them again.

Mac: double-click the file and choose Install Font.

If you installed an earlier version of Humanitarian-Icons, remove it first (Windows: Settings, Personalisation, Fonts, select Humanitarian-Icons, Uninstall), close all GIS programs, then install this one. The new font keeps the same character codes, so existing maps carry on working.

Install in ArcGIS Pro

Install the font first (step 1). The style file was saved with ArcGIS Pro 3.7.

1. Open ArcGIS Pro and open the project you are working on.
2. On the Insert tab, in the Styles group, click Add, then Add Style.
3. Browse to humanitarian-icons-arcgis-pro.stylx and click OK.
4. Open the Catalog pane and expand Styles. The new style is listed there and is ready to use.



Using the symbols

1. Select a point layer and open the Symbology pane.
2. Click the symbol, open the Gallery tab and choose the humanitarian icons style.
3. Search by name, or filter by category, then click the icon you want.

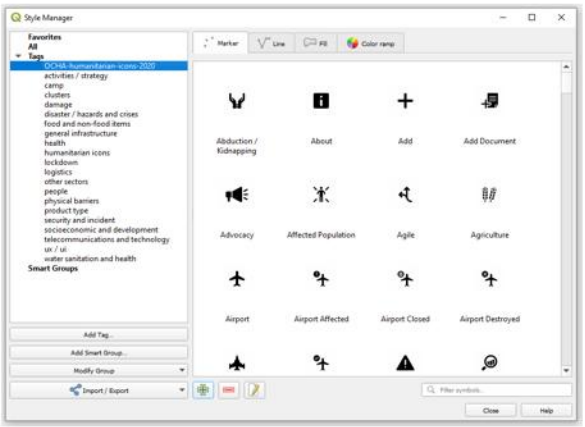
To change the size or colour, open the Properties tab. The halo is a setting of the symbol and is kept when you change the colour.

More help: ArcGIS Pro, add styles to a project (pro.arcgis.com, search for Add a style to a project).

Install in QGIS

Install the font first (step 1), before opening QGIS. This file works in QGIS 3.10 and later.

1. Open QGIS and choose Settings, then Style Manager.
2. Click the Import/Export button at the bottom left of the dialogue and choose Import Item(s).
3. Browse to humanitarian-icons-v3-qgis-ttf.xml. The icons appear in the list.
4. Click Select All, or pick individual icons.
5. If you like, add your own tags in Additional Tag(s). Every symbol already has a tag for its category and the tag humanitarian icons.
6. Click Import. If asked whether to overwrite symbols with the same name, choose Yes.



Using the symbols

1. Open the properties of a point layer and go to Symbology.
2. Choose Single Symbol and pick an icon from the list. Use the search box or the tags to find it.

To change the size or colour, edit the Font marker settings. The halo is a layer effect (outer glow) on the symbol.

Problems and other uses

Icons show as empty boxes or the wrong shape

- The font is not installed, or the program was open while you installed it. Install the font and restart ArcGIS Pro or QGIS.
- An older version of Humanitarian-Icons is still installed. Uninstall it, restart, then install the new font.

The halo is hard to see

The halo is white and half transparent, so it shows most clearly over dark or coloured areas. On a white background it cannot be seen.

Using the font in other programs

You can use the font in any program that supports fonts, for example for labels, documents and slides. Each icon is a character from U+E900 upwards. The full list of icons and character codes is in the icon sheet (Humanitarian-Icons-icon-sheet.pdf) and in documentation/icon-lookup-table.md.

Using the pictures

The SVG and PNG files are black icons for use in reports, websites and presentations. SVG files can be scaled to any size.

Credits

Icons created by the United Nations Office for the Coordination of Humanitarian Affairs (OCHA). GIS formats supported by MapAction.